Hematite banded with jasper

Hematite banded with jasper is alternating iron-rich layers(hematite) and silica-rich layers(jasper).

Characteristics: Hematite-Jasper banded rocks are sedimentary-metamorphic formations typically composed of iron oxides(hematite) interbedded with microcrystalline quartz varieties(jasper).They are often stained red by iron inclusions.These rocks are dense, fine-grained, and display striking red-black banding. Reflecting the alternating episodes of iron oxide precipitation and silica deposition.

Natural occurrences: It is found naturally in ancient, iron-rich regions where these rocks formed billions of years ago on the sea floor. They developed when iron and silica settled in layers, later turning into hard, beautifully banded rocks through pressure and heat. Today, such formations are mostly seen in old continental areas and mining regions. Some well-known places include the Hamersley Range in Australia, Lake Superior region in North America, Jharkhand and Odisha in India, Minas Gerais in Brazil, and the Transvaal Basin in South Africa.

Fun facts: BHJ provides hematite-based red pigments for the paint and coatings industry.